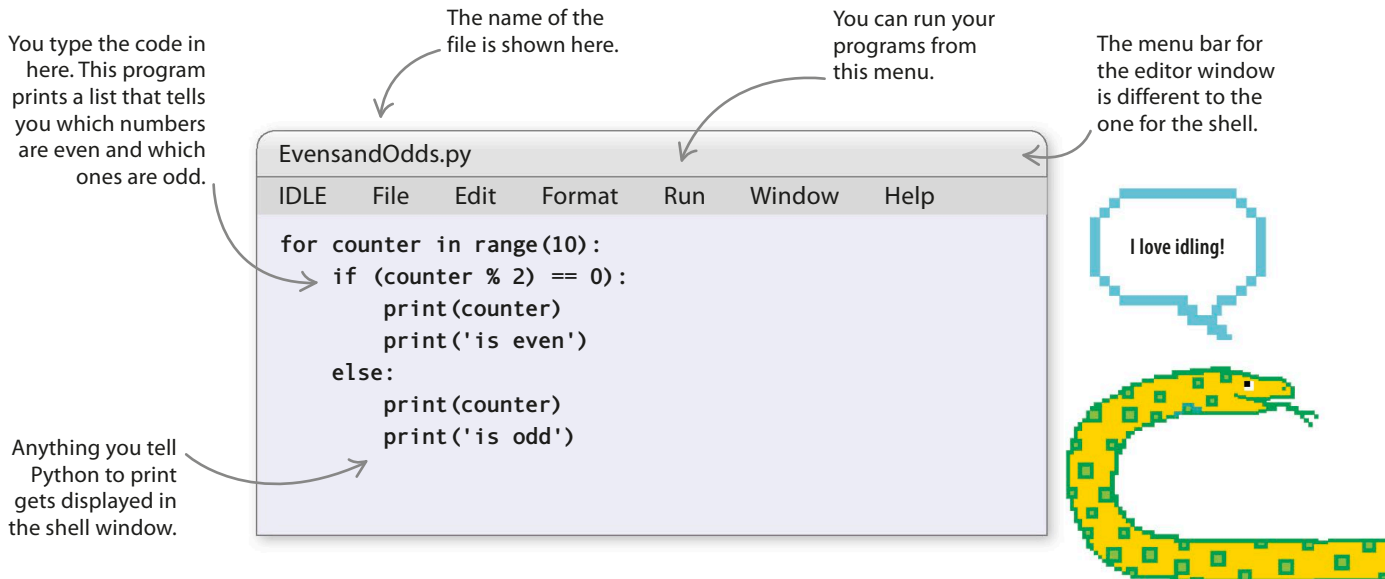


The editor window

The shell can't save your code, so when you close the shell window the code you typed is lost forever. That's why you should use IDLE's editor window when you work on a project. This window lets you save your code. It also has built-in tools to help you write your programs and to trouble-shoot any errors.

▽ The editor window

To open the editor window in IDLE, click on the File menu at the top and choose New File. An empty editor window will then appear. You'll use the editor window to write and run programs for the projects in this book.



EXPERT TIPS

Colours in the code

IDLE automatically colours the text to highlight different parts of the code. The colours make it easier to understand the code, and they're useful when you're trying to spot mistakes.

◁ Built-in commands
Python commands, such as "print", are shown in purple.

◁ Symbols and names
Most code text is coloured black.

◁ Output
Any text produced when a program runs is blue.

◁ Errors
Python uses red to alert you to any errors in your code.

◁ Keywords
Certain words, such as "if" and "else", are special words that Python uses. They are called keywords and are shown in orange.

◁ Text in quotes
Text in quote marks is green. A green bracket around text shows you're missing a quote mark.